

The Subsequent Tantra Called the Vajra Ḍākinī

Vajraḍāka-nāma-uttaratantra · Toh 371 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་མཁའ་འགྲོ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་རྩལ་པ་མྱེ།

Toh 371 in the Kangyur is a Vajrayāna tantric scripture known in English as the Subsequent Tantra Called the Vajra Ḍākinī, in Sanskrit as the Vajraḍāka-nāma-uttaratantra, and in Tibetan as the Rdo rje mkha' 'gro zhes bya ba'i rgyud phyi ma. As its Sanskrit title indicates, it is a "subsequent" or continuation tantra, functioning as a companion or supplementary text to a root tantra of the same cycle centered on Vajraḍākinī, a wrathful and enlightened feminine deity closely associated with secret wisdom, bliss, and the nature of reality. The text belongs to the class of Highest Yoga Tantra and opens with verses extolling Vajraḍākinī as a self-arisen, non-dual primordial wisdom embodied in all women and identified with the supreme bliss that transcends attachment, freedom, and conventional philosophical categories. It sits within the Kangyur's tantric section, where such texts transmitting esoteric teachings on deity yoga, ḍākinī practice, and the realization of awakening through tantric means are collected.

In the language of India: Vajraḍāka-nāma-uttaratantra. In the language of Tibet: The Subsequent Tantra Called the Vajra Ḍākinī.

Homage to the Lord of the World.

Secret, supreme, and blissful,
ever dwelling in the nature of all things —
all ḍākinīs in their very being are bodhisattvas;
Vajra Ḍākinī is the supreme bliss.

She is the self-arisen Blessed One,
she alone is the transcendent deity.
From the source of sound and form arises liberation;
she is the Blessed Ones whose domain is sacred commitment.

She abides perfectly at beginning, end, and middle,
and is rarely found in the three worlds.
She is neither attachment nor freedom from attachment;
neither is she conceived as the Middle Way.

The mudrā of illusion — every woman —
is the supreme non-dual primordial wisdom.

When practiced, even the mother achieves accomplishment;
through bliss and delight, all is attained.

She who accomplishes activity throughout all of space
is renowned as the ḍākinī.

Through union with all ḍākinīs in all their diverse mudrās,
with all their manifold vows,
she is renowned as the Vajra Ḍākinī.

Focusing on one's own deity
is yoga that transcends conceptual thought,
and is born definitively from empowerment.

The yoga of the nature of reflections
is the great yoga, the awakening mind.
The sovereign master of yoga is the self;
the awakening mind is the vajra,
for it is the intrinsic nature of all buddhas.

Therefore, with full and sustained effort,
one should make offering to the manifold intrinsic nature.

Through the nature of mutual embrace in pairs,
it pervades and dwells in all the various classes of beings:
buddhahood itself, the self,
sentient beings, and those with power —
through the yoga of one's own deity,
because that is the very identity of what is to be accomplished,
by this means the suchness of all buddhas
and of all those with power,
everything in the identity of Vajradhara,
will be accomplished in this very life.

Thus was declared by the Blessed One, the glorious Vajrasattva Tathāgata.

Vajra Ḍākinī, supreme bliss,
union with all the ḍākinīs —
the three realms in their entirety,
without exception, bear the characteristic of space.
All things bear the characteristic of space;
all things are like illusions.
Whatever is seen and whatever is touched,

all of it is exactly as an illusion.

Those who dwell everywhere among beings —
not a single one is a fixed object of apprehension.

With this mudrā of the yogin
one travels through the three worlds.
That by which the foolish are bound,
the wise, through that very play, are liberated.

Sentient beings filling the assembly places
arise clearly in various and successive forms.
Form is the buddha Vairocana,
feeling is the Vajra Sun,
perception is Padma, the lord of dance,
likewise formations are Vajra King,
and consciousness is Vajrasattva —
in the intrinsic nature of all things,
this is renowned as Vajra Ḍākinī.

These are of a single great element
that bestows bliss on all.

What is spoken of as with particles and without particles
is the very nature of the great illusion.

The woman of the earth element causes downfall;
the woman of the water element brings death;
the woman of the fire element is the one who draws in;
the lord of dance is likewise the woman of wind.
The nature of the element of space
is the nature of the great illusion.

Through the nature of the five elements,
the chief, the vajra, abides therein.
Through union with all the elements,
she is the supreme ḍākinī, the Blazing One.

The eye is explained as the vajra of delusion;
the ear is explained as the vajra of aversion;
miserliness is the vajra — likewise the nose;
the mouth is spoken of as the vajra of desire;
touch is the vajra of envy.

The union of all sense bases
is Vajra Ḍākinī, the supreme bliss.

Because what is seen by the eye and so forth is empty,
all of this has the nature of emptiness.

Through seeing that is free of conceptual thought,
that becomes unobstructed.

These bear the nature of space.

All of this is mind whose intrinsic nature is space.

When meditation dwells free of obstruction,
non-conceptual thought arises supremely.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the glorious Vajrasattva, the Tathāgata.

The sequential practice of meditative absorption known as "the great-bliss samaya of all Tathāgatas, unobstructed and purposeful" was taught as follows. For as long as the one endowed with supreme knowledge dwells within saṃsāra, the ability to accomplish every aim of sentient beings turns back without match. By this very reason, the noose of existence for noble sentient beings always operates swiftly, with fearlessness and diligent effort, never abandoning the welfare of sentient beings; and because of the purity of aspiration, it extends as far as the expanse of space; and because of the various states of existence, it has the power to accomplish the welfare of sentient beings in whatever the mind desires. These, for the sake of the sons of the gods who are ever filled with the joy of attachment, and furthermore for the sake of those possessed of desire, since attachment is thoroughly purified, great bliss inexhaustible even across an aeon, thoroughly purified, is to be bestowed. From primordial time, having no foundation, manifest throughout all time from the very beginning — from the very first aeon, that great bliss, Vajrasattva too, dwells there as the single supreme deity, the summit of all world-realms, the generator of all sentient beings:

Because of that, the lord of all things —
song and melody and music and the rest —
now abides in bliss throughout all things,
the one who brings forth all bodhisattvas.
Free from attachment to desire,
the bodhisattvas who arise therein
know those who are to be tamed —

they abandon what arises from syllables.

This wisdom is to be venerated.

When it is fully venerated, it is to be venerated.

When fully venerated, existence is exhausted.

"But then, if existence arises from wisdom" —
intrinsic nature is not inert matter.

In just that way, I am feeling,
and beings are spoken of as mere consciousness.

Since by self-awareness these —
there is nothing other than the essence of wisdom.

The egg of Brahmā, spoken of, has no intrinsic nature;
equal to space, it is selfless.

Though sentient beings are many, there is none among them
who possesses the welfare of sentient beings.

Even the welfare of the unsurpassed buddha does not exist.

There is no capacity for one's own welfare, for others' welfare,
or for anything beyond those two.

If one abides constantly in emptiness,
from that the welfare of beings will come.

Without that, all welfare of sentient beings is absent,
and one will proceed even to hell.

Thereupon, moreover, all the buddhas dwelling throughout all the
world-realms assembled and swiftly urged me on:

Mahāsukha Vajrasattva, Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ! Surata, sthāṃ!

The moment I was urged by these,
I bestow bliss upon all.

Desire purified, aim accomplished,
I generate bliss for all beings.

I am the supreme form of desire,
blessed by all the buddhas.

I too am possessed of Dharma-desire,
the sovereign of all buddhas,
the great passion of all buddhas,
the great bliss of all buddhas,
the great body of all buddhas,

the melodious speech of all buddhas,
the great mind of all buddhas,
the great king of all buddhas.
I am the lord of all vajra-holders,
the lord of all lords of the world,
the sovereign lord of all jewels —
and because of engaging in union equally with all ḍākinīs,
even all the buddhas are in equal union.
Because of being equal to all buddhas,
she is proclaimed the Vajra Ḍākinī.

Then the practice of the great maṇḍala is to be performed by drawing all the maṇḍalas. At the center, in what manner:

Vajrasattva is to be set forth —
of moon-white complexion, bearing a gentle smile,
likewise with rays of light, dense and red,
adorned most gloriously with a garland of buddhas,
ornamented with all ornaments,
four-faced and four-armed,
three-eyed, with a crest of matted hair,
united together with four consorts (vidyās),
resplendent with the form of a buddha.
The right face is peaceful and white;
likewise the left is supremely red;
the western face is equally yellow;
enthroned upon a skull, possessed of dance,
the one who makes the gods tremble.
He holds a vajra and a khaṭvāṅga,
and likewise a bell and a skull-cup.
United together with the ḍākinīs,
he is to be drawn on a grand scale —
equal with all the ḍākinīs,
the Vajra Ḍākinī, supreme bliss.

The Blessed One, the vajra-holder Vajrasattva, the Tathāgata, spoke these words:

One should take the mother, the consort herself,
and likewise the female friend — after feasting together,
one engages in union with them pair by pair, enjoying desire,
and thereby bestows all siddhis completely.

Beef, horsemeat, and the like
are to be eaten without obstruction.

In the world, always practice with the left,
and with effort serve and honor with the left hand.
Since all beings — the steady and the moving, and all others —
arise from the left,

one who is without attachment to a female messenger
does not proceed to liberation itself.

Always be attached and liberated in the female messenger.

In this there is no doubt whatsoever.

If the practitioner applies effort to this,
even without ascetic conduct, ascetic conduct is perfected.

Practicing in accordance with the system of sacred commitments (samaya),
eat beautifully in one single act of consumption.

Since it is for the characteristic mark of a single family,
practice equally in all five families.

Honey, vermillion, and camphor,
combined together with red sandalwood —
what arises from the vajra, united together:
these are the five nectars (amṛtas),
and they bestow all siddhis fully.

If one takes what is thick, with its rim sealed,
always receiving it as in yoga,
and tastes it like a peaceful beverage,
one will attain siddhi permanently.

These supreme sacred commitments
have been explained to you, O fair-faced one.
All actions endowed with skillful means
are always to be practiced without obstruction or attachment.

By cultivating non-conceptuality,
this is the supreme of all ascetic practices.

By cultivating non-conceptuality,

all actions are always to be performed.
Conduct that is without obstruction —
that is likewise the supreme of all austerities.
With a mind free of obstruction,
like hair twisted in a tangle,
resting on objects in the mind —
that is the difficult and hard-to-pass austerity.

Whoever practices with certainty in all actions
through wisdom,
endowed with the pith instructions of emptiness —
that is the great self-nature austerity.

With a mind free of conceptuality,
regarding wisdom as like a reflection,
the yoginī who acts without obstruction in what arises —
her austerity is self-nature itself.

There is nothing other than wisdom and skillful means.
By that through which the mind is not made to dwell,
if one dwells correctly in just that way,
great awakening is brought near.

If the yogin abides subsequently in non-conceptuality,
everything that arises for them
is certain to be the Perfection of Wisdom.

Wisdom, like a reflection in a mirror —
conditioned phenomena are just like that.
Through the intelligence of wisdom, mindfulness is to be maintained;
the non-conceptual mind of that
is to be regarded as like a reflection in a mirror,
a dream, an illusion, a water-bubble, an optical illusion —
that is declared to be the principal point.

Like lightning and like a city of smell-eaters (gandharvas),
these conditioned phenomena ripen in this way.
Thus, in perfectly illuminating all things,
that is the supreme pinnacle of their enumeration.
Therefore, the mind is not to be posited as dwelling somewhere.

Arising phenomena such as these — being like an extraordinary illusion — are to be thoroughly and completely enjoyed. From being thoroughly melted by bliss, a certain extraordinary complete enjoyment arises. By being thoroughly transformed into what is good, certain extraordinary results are obtained.

By this, one sees nothing at all in stationary and moving things other than something like a shadow. And when, through the power of cultivating and habituating these very distinctions, one generates the distinguishing purpose of supreme peace and bliss and so forth, one then becomes the substantial cause that makes manifest the unsurpassed fruit — and at that point the Blessed One is utterly without fault.

Therefore, by means of all effort,
one dwells constantly in perfect worship.
Through fierce austerity and suffering,
the deluded are desiccated and tormented,
and by suffering the mind is scattered.
By scattering, there is no attainment.
Bliss becomes utterly stable —
the nature of mind becomes stable —
while through suffering the mind is disturbed
and moves further toward cessation.
When body, speech, and mind
abide in bliss, awakening is attained.
Otherwise, untimely death
and certain fall into hell will come.

Thus did the Blessed One, Vajradhara, Vajrasattva, the Tathāgata, declare these words.

This has been the first chapter, which illuminates the supreme suchness and sets forth the engagement of cognition in its object, from the Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī, the Highest Bliss, the Union with All Ḍākinīs.

Then the goddess made offering to the Blessed One, prostrated, and spoke thus: "Please, Blessed One, speak of that essence by which the malicious are thoroughly tamed — the taming of all the malicious who disparage the teaching of all Tathāgatas, and the taming of all sentient beings such as malicious gods and the like — and of how, having been guided to a state of peace, they remain without acting harmfully until the heart of awakening."

Then the Blessed One, master of the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas,
sang in melody and declared:

First, Vairocana is to be set down.

After that comes the last of the expressors.

In this flow I see the fallen one.

Adorned at the crown of the essence with the third.

To one abiding at the edge of la,
above it, possessing the letter sa.

The second is to be delighted —
that essence bears the letter a.

The entirety at the edge of sa is that very reality.

Expresser and expressed —
seated by the fifth expresser,
adorned with a half-moon and a drop.

From the one dwelling in the center, possessing a tongue,
completely adorned by a burning fringe.

Immediately below the earth that abides there,
the form of wind is joined beneath.

Below that, two short hūṃ hūṃ,
completed together with the letter phaṭ,
fully bearing the real letter aṃ.

That which abides in the center of the fifth —
adorned above by the other i.

Then, mounted on the expresser ra,
dwelling at the crown is the Sovereign,
and the circling of the expresser —
it is to be set down again and again.

The expresser ra is to be engaged,
adorned on the ears with the letter e.

Then that very expresser ra
is again to be engaged with the fifth.

This too is entirely thus:

the expresser adorned at the head with a half-moon.

Together with the fifth, it becomes twofold.

That very supreme protector of all,
adorned with phaṭ and precious things —
ha is indeed the very conclusion.

All the assembled hosts of Vairocana are to be utterly delighted.

Thus did the Blessed One, Vajrasattva the Tathāgata, declare these words, bound by the vow-net of the ḍākinīs who unite with the six heroes:

Here, arising from the letter hūṃ,
is the maṇḍala of the variegated lotus and solar disc.

The karma vajra dwelling in the center —
that very hūṃ is to be fully contemplated.

From it the wheel of ḍākinīs blazes forth,
bearing many streams of light.

One face, two arms, three eyes,
red in color, and greatly fierce,
sounding with the cry of terrifying things —
three eyes, hair bristling upward and tawny.

Youthful and of surpassing excellence,
wrapped at the hips in tiger skin,
a great terrifier with lolling tongue,
she who terrifies even the terrifying,
uniting equally with all ḍākinīs —
she is fully accomplished as the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Thus did the Blessed One, Vajradhara, Vajrasattva the Tathāgata, declare these words.

Now, as before in sequence,
declare the equal-to-fire, twice stated,
then join ka-ra-ka-ra as the seventh.
Bandha likewise is the enemy-heart syllable —
this too is to be uttered twice.

For the sa-class: ma and a,
dwelling at the end of the world, free of form —
this nature too is to be uttered twice.

It is to be combined with the others and the others.
Bha and ja, dwelling close together —
these are to be uttered twice.

For the vocative, the third,
it is to be combined with what dwells within.
Then adorn it with the half young-moon,

and complete it fully with the full-moon ornament.
These are to be uttered again and again.
Make it complete with the nature of the one who makes the day,
and join the vocative with the invitation-place;
at the fifth, it becomes doubled.
For the phe syllable, fierce and swift,
it is to be joined with the young-moon,
and once more it is to be uttered.
Fierce and swift utterance: pha-ṭ, twice.
The kindling-wood of all conceptual thought —
burning, burning: da-ha da-ha.
This calling mantra, the cry of those words,
is to be joined as the second, close to the fifth.
A, and then again truly complete,
the vocative, the chief, and again complete —
it is to be uttered again and again:
bha-kṣa bha-kṣa, followed by
va-sa-ru-dhī-ra, and then
a-ntra-mā-lā-va-la-mbi-ne,
grī-hṇa grī-hṇa, and then
sapta-vātāla-ka — join these.
Bhu-jaṃga and sarva-mbā,
tar-ja-ya — this is uttered twice.
From the ka-class, ka itself:
join the second and the fourth.
It abides in the nature of wind.
Declare: i-ending, sa-ending,
adorned with seven suns as its abode.
With the fourth, the vocative is adorned.
It is to be uttered again and again.
Ka, śa, o, and the pa-class —
below that, the first is placed.
To ra and to har, both joined,
attach two bindu-dots.
Declare a, and then the class-seed.
With the fourth of the class,
the first is to be combined.

The third also joins with the first,
and the third is to be pleased with that as well.
The vocative too, the vocative —
is to be combined with the seat of i.
The sa-class adorned with e, ra,
bearing a moon-crescent and a bindu —
this is to be uttered again and again.
That same e is joined with the fourth direction.
Then again and again it is recited.
Join the vocative with the fourth,
and at the end place la, joined with i —
that too is recited again and again.
Join the vocative syllable ha as well,
crowned above with the moon-crescent and bindu.
The fifth too is to be pleased.
That too is recited again and again.
Accomplishing the limitless multitude,
heaping up abundant flowers of virtue —
this is the great goddess of illusion,
the bestower of all siddhis.

Just as this was proclaimed, at that very moment
the entire world-system shook.
All the Tathāgatas were startled,
and all the Tathāgatas once again
achieved perfect and complete awakening.
All the mountains trembled and cracked.
All wickedness was subdued — tamed and pacified.
Summoned into the maṇḍala, they were led inside,
bound by samaya vows, gathered under dominion.
The hosts of mother-spirits and of elemental beings,
all planetary spirits and epidemic afflictions,
yakṣas, rākṣasas, those led astray,
the malevolent, and all hell-beings —
were commanded, driven back, and utterly shattered.

Thus did the Blessed One, Vajradhara, Vajrasattva the Tathāgata, the supreme
bliss of the Vajra-ḍākinī who unites equally with all ḍākinīs, declare these

words.

The square form with four gates,
complete with their gate-guardians —
in the center of that, draw the vajra.

Crimson in color, blazing with great radiance,
encircled on the outside by a ring of round designs.
In the center of that stands the Blessed One,
the great wrathful one, whose face is beautifully adorned —
slightly baring fangs, with a fearsome and awe-inspiring gaze,
yet slightly smiling, his face breaking into laughter.

His right face is white, peaceful;
his left face is red, greatly terrifying;
his western face is golden in hue.

Attended equally by the four goddesses,
he is magnificently adorned with four arms.
The one who subdues the four māras of terror,
he is beautifully arrayed in the form of a buddha.

The hero holds a khaṭvāṅga staff on the right,
and a skull-cup on the left.

Draw a blazing vajra on the right —
that is the special attribute of the skull.

The hero holds a bow and arrow,
and is supremely adorned with the consort of wisdom and bliss.
The blazing red maṇḍala shines forth,
endowed with the bodhisattvas blazing and coiling.

At the time of great terror,
he blazes like the fire of the charnel ground.

His great blazing hair shines brilliantly,
his crown ornament distinguished by skulls.

When all the retinues and celebrations are gathered,
Heruka engages in the dance.

In the supreme sacred place of the Wheel of the Mother-Spirits,
he is the sovereign lord of all grounds.

Entirely and in every respect complete,
he himself forever encompasses all.

All ḍākinīs unite with him in union.

The supremely blissful Vajra-ḍākinī —

through the supreme application of recitation and meditation,
there is no doubt that accomplishment will be attained here.

By practicing at the junctures of the sessions,
one should meditate upon the supreme vow.

Upon completing one hundred thousand recitations, the great Vajra
transforms into union with the king of wrathful ones.

One comes to possess the life, complexion, youth,
form, strength, and diligence
of the great Vajra-holder,
and attains great miraculous accomplishment.

One becomes capable of accomplishing the benefit of sentient beings.

Alternatively, through the meditative absorption of secret mantra,
even a small amount of recitation

will accomplish roughly a hundredfold of activities —

namely: definitively subduing all that is stable and all that moves; causing to fall; causing to destroy; sealing; rendering mute; rendering delirious; granting release; causing bewilderment; binding; scattering; bringing under dominion; utterly transforming; causing madness; transforming and driving out; causing hatred; destroying wealth and causing terror; causing to act like a madwoman; causing to tremble with dread; binding oneself and causing to writhe; beating; causing blindness; destroying the seed; gripping with plague, internal disease, and poison; causing to take effect through one's own exertion; causing to fall into hell; utterly transforming the abodes of animals; causing a man to become a woman; causing a young child to fall from the womb; binding the sexual organ; rendering androgynous; equalizing one who is attached and lusting; causing wild agitation and binding; causing one to be killed by another; making weapons strike; fulfilling all needs; instantly driving out; stripping naked; causing the sexual organ and the anus to cry out; causing the sexual organ and the anus to act freely; turning semen to blood; swiftly removing diseases; wasting away leprosy and similar diseases arising from blood; binding and afflicting with grief and suffering; tearing apart limb by limb; grinding all embodied beings to powder and killing them; drawing in with universal longing; inserting; shaking; trembling; laughing; continuously causing all sentient beings to speak nonsense; showing as though obtaining each of the former states individually; applying oneself completely to all activities of bringing under dominion; rendering into servants; taming all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, misleading spirits, elemental beings, mother-spirits,

and all ḍākinīs; bestowing wealth; and earth, water, fire, and wind, and commanding all of space; prevailing over Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and the Great God (Śiva); destroying all attachment; liberating from epidemic disease, plague, poison, and all ḍākinīs; piercing all the Tathāgatas who are free from attachment; destroying the weariness of cyclic existence in all bodhisattvas. All of these are declared to be accomplishments wrought by all the goddesses. These very kings of mantras, however, will never arise where they have not yet arisen.

The Blessed One, Vajradhāra, the Tathāgata Vajrasattva, thus declared this perfected siddhi of union with all the illusions of the ḍākinīs. These are taken from the great Vajra Ḍākinī Tantra, constituting the chapter on the rites of the entire collection of activities and the mantra-rite of the emanations of the great magical display — this is the second chapter.

Then the secret should be spoken.
Since it is summarized it is not extensive.
When all are united with illusion as equal,
all activities are made equal.
All the illusions of the great accomplishment,
all sovereignty is perfectly accomplished.
The vidyā that radiates and disperses
summons the possessing spirits of the elemental beings.

Hī ma ban tsa ye ut ta re ṇa bha batsi bo na ma. Mahā ma so. So ba i a dha ma siṃ be hi ma se hi ma se hi ba ti bud dha i. I so. Ni do. Ma hi. Nī to. Kum bha kaṇḍa. Sin na do. Sā ga ra sa satya pa ḍa be sin na sin na daṃ. Baṅghā mi. Ku rur sas sva bi ḍa la sa. Tuṇḍa ban dha me. Jā ba su ra u da ni. Ja ba ra bi pa bha a dhi a ha to bar ṇa a nu ba da na sā dhu na. Ma ma ri a sar bha si dha na svā hā.

The Blessed One, Vajradhāra, the Tathāgata Vajrasattva, declared: by pronouncing this seven times with earnest recitation and placing it on the roof of a house, it will cause speech.

Ba sa ha to la i mi jñā a. Ba sa ba ja na mo hi a. E sa bijja ca ha in man ta i in dha na. Ha a bā i ja be na diṇṇa ṇi. Dha tam pa hi ma hā sva ba a na ne bā dho si. Rā ja ku la kaṇḍa. Ḍa ṇi ḍa. Je bā i ba dha. Ta dhi ṇa ta ṇa. Namaḥ sid dha na. Namaḥ pu pa ja ja pā da na. Ma sa va rā ṇe. Tadyathā re ma hā daṇḍe da ha he dun he he svā hā.

By pronouncing this seven times over sand and casting it upon grain, jackals and other animals will not eat it, and it will turn back clouds.

Ratna rati. Oṃ a la la bar tsu li la tsor brgha ka na da sa bā mu ha baṅghā mi svā hā.

By reciting this seven times over a four-finger-length piece of wood and tying it to the right ear, it will cause thieves to be roused and flee.

I da si. A ti ṇi ja ha a ka li lo hi di. Piṅga le. Ma me ga bha na i. Ahaṃ si la u sa ri mi a ba ra bha ṇa i. Ahaṃ bā da u sā ra mi a ba ra bha ṇa mi ahaṃ du ha mi bhi to bad dha pa. Mi lo lo ka li lo hi di paṇ ga li hūṃ phaṭ.

Take soil from the middle of a field that has been ploughed by a bull's horn, apply this mantra to it seven times, and it will protect against harm from wild forests, fearsome roads, seizure by a king, and all such dangers. Having made the bull's face, perform this rite: place that soil in the hand. Against falling hail and the like, apply it and it will be turned back. This is the rite for this.

Oṃ jaṃ pi li a ba a bijji su ti tha da si. I su bha de su bha de o. So ṇa o a ca la hi suṇṇa pa da ne. I si la ba da ba ra ṣa bad dha hi svā hā.

Fill a fine vessel with water, sit in a fitting place, recite seven times, and throw that water into the sky — it will cause hail and wind and the like to be turned back and dispersed.

Na a mo dhe. Bha ga ba ti. Ki bhi ku re ṇa śa tra ya.

Tha ma ke ha tha ka ral pā ke. Ni ta saṃ ru bi ti bha tu ya. Ru dza ri ṭa raṃ ṭa ku ke to li ṭa lu ya. Lu taṃ hiṣṭha le ka si ra le lo ti gra le bhi ṣi ṣa le ṇa si mu le kha a ya the sar bha ha de sra na bhu dza ku bha na su the ra ṣa ya na pa ya ra ti ṣu dha ya na śo pa dya ti ta ka su sa la ka kha se sid dha ba hā la sa hi pa ṇa svā hā.

Recite over water seven times and wash the face with it, and it accomplishes everything.

Then, having arranged the ḍākinīs in sequence upon Heruka and the petals, apply them without allowing the breath to escape. There is no doubt that accomplishment comes from this.

Furthermore, for practitioners here:

Having fully contemplated the lotus,

having made the mind waveless,

if the mantra is applied to a female messenger,

through that, accomplishment will always arise —
of this the mantra-practitioner has no doubt.

This is the third chapter of the glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then, furthermore, what is to be explained: for the purpose of union with the six heroines, there are six heroes to be fully understood. At each of the places, there is a syllable. The first is at the heart itself. The second is said to be at the head. The third is given at the crown of the head. The fourth is at the shoulders, as armor. The fifth is at the eyes. The sixth is said to be at all of them.

This is the fourth chapter of the glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then, furthermore, what is to be explained: the supreme assembly of all ḍākinīs — where they are pleased, that is the summary of all ḍākinīs. Practice at the four haunts of hungry ghosts, or else at the seashore, or at the four crossroads of a road, and accomplish all supreme attainments. At a mountain cave or forest, and likewise what is called a solitary tree — having practiced there by night in a fearsome form, the highest unsurpassed yoga will arise. There, one will dwell constantly together with the ḍākinīs — of this the practitioner has no doubt.

This is the fifth chapter of the glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

The rites of prior conduct have been fully explained — now hear, O goddess. The yogin practicing austerities should not dwell with others. Neither should the body be supremely honored, nor should it be treated with contempt. View all variety as equal in intrinsic nature. Smear the body with charnel-ground ash and adorn it with effort using ashes. As for what is food and what is not food and so forth, the mantra-practitioner should make no distinctions whatsoever. With all flowers found, wherever they are found, always make garlands.

This is the sixth chapter of the glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then the collection of activities of the armor is to be explained. Whatever essence there is in the three worlds — if it is mixed with the fruit that causes madness, all is accomplished in an instant. If one goes while reciting the armor mantra, the gods themselves cannot see one, and one has no fear of thieves, tigers, and the like. If one enters a king's town while reciting the armor mantra and with blessing applied, one may take what one desires without being seen and then return with it. Furthermore, whoever is touched by one reciting the

armor mantra will become stiff and rigid as if bound in a knot, and even the thirty-three gods cannot move them. If they are then pressed with the foot of the one reciting the mantra, they will be released once more.

This is the seventh chapter of the glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then the activities of the root mantra are explained. From the full application using an effigy made of the five meats, all activities are performed. Gods, asuras, nāgas, all yakṣas, all gandharvas (dri za), and all the abodes of the gods come at the mere thought. It causes clouds to be frightened away, causes rain to fall, causes it to be turned back, causes the ocean to dry up, causes river currents to be reversed, and causes the sense faculties to be paralyzed. As much as one desires, recite over charnel-ground ash, and whoever is then touched by it will fall in that very instant. Having completely recited over charnel-ground ash,

whoever is touched by it will, in that very instant, seize upon flesh as food.

This is the eighth chapter of the Glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī.

Now, yet further matters are to be explained.

The conduct of the ḍākinīs,
the one who has taken on the courage and bravery of the hero,
she who has been made to serve as messenger —
the hero is to engage with the beautiful one.

Using the earth as a support,
recite the mantra of sacred conduct.

The manner of rising that reverses the sequence,
the face with the terrifying intrinsic nature of the mouth,
the countenance constantly held like a madwoman,
and swift comprehension of the sequence of dharmas —
these are the characteristic behaviors of a ḍākinī.

The three signs, entirely rounded,
she knows the sequence and its reversal just as they are;
by her going and coming —
these are the defining marks of all the characteristics of a ḍākinī.

With a furrowed brow like one loosening a knot,
whatever causes her to turn back —
from that, the vajra hook is clearly revealed.
Her voice is the sound of the cuckoo (kokila).

The authentic yogin who recognizes such a being as she truly is
will be granted attainment.

If one contemplates her defining marks,
one will thereby become her very own.

This is the ninth chapter of the Glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī.

The one who supremely bestows all attainments —
listen, goddess, as I explain.

Body, speech, and mind, at all times,
should be freed from the dust of conceptuality.

In order to unite with all ḍākinīs,
one should meditate thoroughly on the maṇḍala of the body.
The female messenger does not dwell in any particular place.
She will not come merely through extensive meditation;
she is to be grasped through faith alone,
not through the eye or the hand.

This secret is not to be revealed openly
but is to be concealed with great effort.

Regard all the yoginīs as a gathering.

Therefore, do not look upon them as mere physical bodies.

This is the tenth chapter of the Glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī.

Now, yet further matters are to be explained:

the sphere of activity of one who practices samaya.

By guarding samaya fully, full accomplishment is achieved;
one abides as a mantra-practitioner by virtue of samaya.

Always relying on the power of fruit that has arisen,
do not disparage the yoginīs.

Do not turn away those who enter into the practice.

Do not disparage those who are bound by samaya.

Do not harm those who are diligent.

Associate with such people and act for their well-being.

For the sake of one who desires liberation,
the samayas are to be practiced.

What the buddhas have declared —

do not disparage even the slightest of it.

Do not perform angry and forceful rituals against anyone.

Do not direct them against the mantra.

This is the eleventh chapter of the Glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī.

The method of accomplishing the Vajra Ḍākinī —
listen, goddess, as I explain.

First, one is to meditate on the corpse itself,
recognizing it as the purified dharmadhātu.

Upon that, the capable yogin,
having meditated upon the supreme state of realization,
arranges everything within that very reality.

At the center of the moon disk within one's own heart,
all the goddesses are drawn forth from light.

Homage, offerings, and the rest are recited as follows.

First, within the heart, at the center of the moon,
visualize the moon disk with the syllable A,
and above it, meditate upon the syllable HŪṂ.

Then, having generated a mind of loving-kindness,
thereafter draw the maṇḍala for a time.

Four-sided, with four gates,
it is definitively marked at the border by a vajra torana.

Properly possessing four cords,
beautifully adorned with garlands of bells —
at all the corners of the maṇḍala and at the intervals of the gate-frames,
marked with vajras and jewels,
draw the outer line of the maṇḍala.

One endowed with wisdom draws the lines.
Beautifully adorned with a garland of wheels,
and within that, draw a lotus,
brilliantly white in color.

And above that as well,
a red lotus, endowed with light,
encircled by a garland of lotuses.

The mantra-practitioner also draws, densely packed within that,
a garland of vajras.

Or alternatively, a great lotus of eight petals,
equal in brilliance to indranīla (sapphire).

At its center, adorned with five maṇḍalas,

and to the right abides the principal vajra deity.
Above Mount Meru,
manifesting in varied and pleasing forms —
all buddhas and bodhisattvas,
please turn your attention toward me.

This is the ninth chapter of the Glorious Great Tantra of the Vajra Ḍākinī.

I, whose name is called Great She,
from this moment forward,
until awakening is attained,
just as the Protectors of the three times
have definitively resolved upon awakening —
the unsurpassable awakening mind (bodhicitta),
sublime and supreme, I shall arouse.

The discipline of moral training,
the gathering of virtuous qualities,
and the moral discipline of acting for the benefit of sentient beings —
these three forms of ethical conduct
I shall individually uphold with firmness.

In the vow of the buddha-yoga,
in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha,
in the unsurpassable Three Jewels —
from this day forward I shall take refuge.

In the supreme and great vajra family,
in the vajra, the bell, and the mudrās,
I shall hold truly and authentically.
I shall also take refuge in the teachers.

In the yoga of the supreme and precious jewel family,
the pleasing sacred commitments (samaya) —
each and every day, again and again,
the fourfold gift I shall always bestow.

Arising from the great awakening,
in the pure and great lotus family —
the outer, inner, and secret teachings,
the three vehicles of the sacred Dharma,

each one I shall uphold separately.

In the supreme and great karma family,
endowed with all vows —

I shall uphold them truly and authentically.

And the acts of offering too I shall perform to the best of my ability.

The awakening mind, unsurpassable and sublime —

I shall arouse it.

For the sake of all sentient beings

I shall take up all vows.

Those not yet liberated, I shall liberate.

Those not yet freed, I shall free.

Those not yet relieved, I shall give relief.

I shall establish sentient beings in nirvāṇa.

Oṃ svabhāvaśuddhāḥ sarvadharmāḥ svabhāvaśuddho 'ham.

Then, contemplating all things as being without self, established in their
ground, and free from degradation, know that the Blessed One, the
Vajra-Holder (Skt. Vajrasattva), the Tathāgata —

deep blue in color, supremely fierce,

adorned with a garland of skulls,

four-armed and four-faced,

beautiful with three eyes —

makes the great hungry ghost his throne,

abides upon the sun, performing his dance.

He bears a skull-cup and a khaṭvāṅga (Skt. khaṭvāṅga, a trident-staff), a bow,
and likewise an arrow.

Visualize this sequence of ritual in the aspects of primordial wisdom.

To the east, white with a blue sheen:

in the left hand a khaṭvāṅga and bell,

a vajra and skull-cup, and others likewise.

To the north, red or slightly golden:

in the left hand a khaṭvāṅga and lasso,

in the right hand a clapper-drum and skull-cup.

To the west, reddish or slightly golden:

strenuously grasping bow and arrow,

and skull-cups of varied kinds and lotuses
in the right and left hands.

To the south, white or golden:
in the left hand a three-pointed precious jewel,
in the right hand likewise a skull-cup.

In the skull-cups, according to the rite:
an elephant, a jackal, a human, and an ox —
the first is she who causes downfall,
the second is she who slays,
the third is she who summons,
the fourth is the mistress of the dance.

These wisdom-consorts, their hair
blazing upward, adorned with ornaments,
abide and perform the dance.

In the skull-cups situated at the four quarters
are adorned close by with the five forms of the buddhas,
replete with the supreme drink.

The first is wholly replete with syllables.
Contemplate it as blazing in an instant.

Having thus visualized the goddess in this way,
one attains the accomplishment (Skt. *siddhi*) of the fruit of wealth.
The great *vidyā*-practice becomes accomplished —
contemplate it fully, directly and perfectly.

All places appearing invisible to ordinary sight:
the practitioner of yoga perceives them in a flash.
The women born of the supreme deity,
moving through all buddhas, roaming freely.

Those buddhas equal in number to the sands of the Ganges,
abiding in the seat of the three vajras —
with an *āmalaka* fruit resting in one's own palm,
one will behold them with vajra-eyes.

Buddhafiels equal in number to the sands of the Ganges,
marked by the body, speech, and mind of the buddhas —
the actual mind, the actual dancer, and all phenomena:

one will behold them all as one's own nature.

Tantras and mantras — when their visualizations are cultivated
and their syllables joined in reversed sequence —
these supreme and secret teachings
have been well expounded to you.

All the ḍākinīs united in equal union:
the Vajra-ḍākinī, supreme bliss.

Vajrasattva, the Tathāgata —
the Blessed One of the Vajra spoke thus.

This is the twelfth chapter, the Chapter on the Arising of the Great
Vajra-ḍākinī, from the Great Tantra of the Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then: the bestower of all accomplishments,
the one who swiftly brings forth accomplishment
and generates it without doubt —
the essence of the ḍākinī is now explained.

Apply the mantra equally to the two signs.
Hero and ḍākinī are nondual —
these matters of supreme union
are to be accomplished perfectly by the yoginī.
By this, accomplishment is well renowned.

Gods, asuras, and humans alike —
all objectives are swiftly accomplished by this.
What is always near, in accordance with reality,
and what is far — by this, too, it is swiftly produced.
Those that draw near
are summoned into the form body of that one.

At the center of the lotus, one abides supremely,
and cultivates through the sign of the breath.
There one visualizes the variegated body,
makes offerings to the variegated body,
comprehends the awakening mind,
and perfectly unites it with oneself.

Joining in union with the ḍākinī,
one should remain there as the sky itself.

All sources of arising are precisely that —
there all ḍākinīs are present.

The ḍākinī of the place and the source of arising —
she abides in all domains.

In every domain the one endowed with birth is born.
She is rightly expounded as the place of self-arising.

The ḍākinī who enters the maṇḍala —
from that time forward, consume her from the east onward.
Having joined perfectly in union with her,
the mantra practitioner should always accomplish this fully.

There, engaging in great play,
accomplish everything as though it were illusion.
Having made the sacred bond one's own intrinsic nature,
from that the vow arises supremely.
In the non-luminous joy, it is self-aware.

This is the thirteenth chapter from the glorious Great Tantra of the
Vajra-ḍākinī.

Then: what is to be rightly explained —
the auspicious maṇḍala of the mothers,
all the sādhana methods of all the deities,
the distinctions of the messengers,
the elemental spirits, possessing spirits, and the great vidyā,
the various corpses,
and likewise the mantra garlands —
thus explained: now listen, O goddess.

With four sides and four gates,
complete with the gatekeepers,
the ground of all accomplishments and qualities —
draw the maṇḍala beautifully.

Endowed with the five qualities of desire,
adorned with the five enjoyments,
the artist must be one who holds the sacred bond;
have the supreme practitioner draw it.

Either cloth wrapped around a corpse,
or food pierced with a weapon —
cloth for the elemental spirits,
just a bit of ox-hide:
at eight or fourteen of the dark days,
accomplish the maṇḍala of the elemental spirits.

If one recites a hundred thousand times,
they will appear directly before one.
Brahmāṇī and Maṅgalā,
Kaumārī and Vārāhī,
Aindrī and Cāmuṇḍā,
Cakreśvarī,
and the mistress of the Byin-za.

In the second ring:
Brahmā, Yama, the water deity,
Kubera, the hungry ghost,
Byin-za, Indra,
the truthless one, and likewise the wind deity.

In the third ring:
the sun and the moon,
the red-eyed one and the planet retinue,
Bṛhaspati and Rāhu,
Śani and Ketu.

In the fourth ring, at the four gates:
Brahmā and Viṣṇu, likewise,
Rudra and Kārtika,
earth, water, fire, and wind —
the four great elements.

At the very center of the first ring,
in the four cardinal directions, the ḍākinī —
Dīpā, Śobhā,
Bhairavī, and likewise —
and at the center abides the lord of pervasion.

Proceeding to the ultimate limit in perfect truth,
in accordance with the rite, by its intrinsic nature,
the yogin is to accomplish this.

Through the engagement of the great maṇḍala,
likewise draw the outer maṇḍala.

At the center, within a perfectly round form,
encircle it with supremely beautiful designs.
Draw an eight-petaled lotus
with concealed navel and with movement.

At its center, the great wrathful one:
one face, four arms.

With fangs slightly bared,
bearing a face that is faintly laughing,
deep blue in color, greatly terrible,
adorned with a garland of skulls.
He dances on a single corpse, seated in the sun,
the one who strikes terror into the gods.
Wrapped below in a tiger's skin,
endowed with the supreme form of three eyes.
In the right hand, a blazing vajra;
in the left, a three-pronged spear.
Likewise, right and left hands hold a bow and arrow.

To the east, draw the ḍākinī.
To the south is she who is the Terrifying One.
To the west is the Beautiful Goddess.
To the north, place the Flame-Bearer.

She who arises from the syllable Hrīḥ:
Vajravārāhī, one face, four arms,
with bow and arrow likewise,
and a victory banner and a skull.
Blue in color, greatly terrifying,
making beings fearful with her sow's face.

She who brings blessing, arisen from the syllable Phaṭ:
red in color, four-armed,
holding a skull and an iron hook,
likewise a khaṭvāṅga staff and a small bell.

From the syllable Ha, the Young One:
yellow in color, four-armed,

with a trident and a three-pronged spear,
likewise a bow and an arrow.

From the syllable Ho, the Ancient-Faced One:
black in color, four-armed,
with a khaṭvāṅga and a skull,
likewise a sword and a small bell.

Arisen from the syllable Bhaṃ, the Brahmin Woman:
white in color, four-armed,
with a lotus and a skull,
likewise in another pair, a bow and arrow.

Arisen from the syllable Gha, the Mistress of Hosts:
smoke-blue in color, four-armed,
with a trident, and likewise a skull,
a counting rosary, and a lute.

Arisen from the syllable Paṃ, the All-Pervading Woman:
blue in color, four-armed,
holding a club and a skull,
likewise a lasso and a sword.

Arisen from the syllable — the Mistress of the Senses:
yellow in color, four-armed,
a blazing vajra and a skull,
a threatening finger and a lasso.

All of them with hair blazing upward,
adorned with varied ornaments,
with three eyes, mounted on corpses,
wrapped below in tiger skins.

At the eastern gate, draw Brahmā:
white in color, four-faced,
holding a skull, a counting rosary,
incense, and a lotus.

To the north, likewise Viṣṇu:
black in color, four-armed,
with a sword, likewise a wheel,
a skull, and a staff.

To the south, draw the Fierce One:
smoke-colored, four-armed,
holding a trident and a kapāla skull-cup,
likewise a lasso and a counting rosary.

To the west, draw Kārtikā:
yellow in color, four-armed,
a heroic blazing figure holding a staff,
likewise a skull and a counting rosary.

Mounted on the lord of birds, the mighty one:
white in color, four-armed,
holding a skull and a trident,
and the remaining pair with palms joined.

The Lord mounted on an elephant:
yellow in color, four-armed,
holding a vajra and a skull,
the remaining pair with palms joined together.

The holder of the fire direction, mounted on a goat:
red in color, four-armed,
holding a fire-pot and a skull,
the other pair, in fear, with palms joined.

Yama mounted on a mahiṣa buffalo:
black in color, four-armed,
holding a staff and a skull,
likewise the other pair, in fear, with palms joined.

Mounted on a dog, the one without truth:
green in color, four-armed,
holding a sword and a skull,
the rest in fear with palms joined.

The water direction: mounted on a makara sea-creature,
white in color, four-armed,
holding a lasso and a skull,
the others joining palms together.

The wind: mounted on a deer,
smoke-colored, four-armed,
holding a banner and a skull,

likewise the remaining pair with palms joined.

The Wealth-Giver mounted on a treasure,
yellow in color, four-armed,
holding a jewel and a skull,
the others joining their palms.

All the planets and constellations
are to be contemplated, each in their own maṇḍala.
Arisen from their own pledges,
endowed with great power and miraculous ability:
the mother of all mothers,
likewise the supreme one who has become the knowledge —

Hear this, O Great Goddess supreme!
Each torma is to be taken up one by one.
She who most excellently bestows all accomplishments —
if one always dwells in the dance of yoga,
the method of accomplishing the messenger who, through diligent effort,
becomes the bearer:
this is excellently expounded.
Hard to find in all the tantras,
by means of this one shall come to accomplishment.

Dwelling constantly in solitary yoga,
one is definitively freed from the faults of cyclic existence.
The messenger, having become beloved, is forever liberated.
One should practice by means of the supreme sequence.
Mere respectful attendance is not sufficient.
Even one born in a lowly station becomes a dwelling of joy and bliss.

Mother, sister, daughter,
and wife too may abide as messengers.
In the world one always acts with the left:
the left foot is extended forward,
the whole movement is carried out with the left hand,
the left is the first to make offering,
turning is done toward the left side,
and it is through the left, with effort, that one is satisfied.

This is the fourteenth chapter of the great tantra, the Essence of the Glorious Vajra Ḍākinī.

The condensed essence of the subsequent tantra of the Glorious Vajra Ḍākinī is hereby complete.

Translated from the presence of the great paṇḍita of India, Parameśvara, and the Tibetan monk Śākya Brtsongrus, in the solitary hermitage in the valley of the divine painted cliff at Lag Rgyang Phu in Grom.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "the woman of the earth element causes downfall" and the parallel lines about water, fire, wind, and space describe the five female figures (ḍākinīs) associated with the five elements in Vajrayāna cosmology. The verb forms are technically active participial constructions identifying each elemental ḍākinī by her characteristic function or action within tantric practice; these are not negative descriptions but roles within the maṇḍala system.

The expression "Vajra Sun" in the line on feeling corresponds to a deity-figure Vajrasūrya, one of the five vajra-family consorts or male equivalents in some schemas; the reading "Padma, the lord of dance" for perception renders a figure associated with Amitābha's family and the dance-lord epithet common for Padmaṇṛteśvara.

The closing section on the sense faculties as five vajras maps the five afflictions (delusion, aversion, miserliness, desire, envy) onto the five senses, a standard Vajrayāna transformation schema.

- The passage contains several verses of pronounced doctrinal complexity where the philosophical argument moves rapidly between statements about emptiness, self-awareness (rang rig pa), the nature of existence arising from wisdom, and the negation of "inert matter" as intrinsic nature. The verse sequence beginning "But then, if existence arises from wisdom" reads as an internal dialectical exchange, with the objection and reply compressed into adjacent lines; this is rendered accordingly. The rendering of gdod ma nas gnas gzhi med pa as "having no foundation from primordial time" follows the standard Vajrayāna reading of the term as pointing to primordial groundlessness rather than a deficiency.

The mantra line "Mahāsukha Vajrasattva, Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ! Surata, sthāṃ!" preserves the Sanskrit and seed syllables as they appear in the Tibetan, since they are liturgical and not translatable. "Surata" (meaning "union" or "love-making") and "sthāṃ" ("remain" or "be stable") are left in Sanskrit as standard tantric imperatives.

- The passage describes Vajrasattva in a multi-faced, multi-armed tantric form. The verse "the western face is equally yellow" follows a directional color scheme for the four faces; the fourth face, presumably the eastern, was described as moon-white in the preceding passage. The text does not explicitly name the fourth direction here, so the reconstruction follows standard directional logic.

The phrase rendered "eat beautifully in one single act of consumption" is deliberately ambiguous in the original; it may refer to ritual feast consumption of the five nectars described shortly after, a common tantric sacramental practice.

The term rendered "smell-eaters" is a standard gloss for gandharvas, semi-divine beings in Indian cosmology said to subsist on fragrances; their "city" is a classic Indian simile for illusion,

equivalent to a mirage.

The final prose section uses the language of yogic non-dual experience and bliss-transformation characteristic of highest yoga tantra; the phrasing "complete enjoyment" renders a term closely associated with the sambhogakāya principle in that context.

- The central passage of this chapter is a sādhana-style instruction encoding a mantra syllable by syllable. The Tibetan presents each element with terms like "expresser" (rjod byed, i.e., the letter or syllable that expresses) and cryptic references to letters: sa, la, a, ra, e, phaṭ, hūṃ, aṃ, and so on. These are standard Vajrayāna syllable-combination instructions, often called "twilight language" or intentional language (saṃdhyābhāṣā). The precise mantra being constructed is not spelled out openly; the translation preserves the cryptic pedagogical style as found in the original rather than reconstructing the mantra explicitly, which would be beyond the scope of a faithful rendering and is deliberately veiled in the source text.

The phrase rendered "the fallen one" (lhung nga yis mthong, literally "I see the fallen") is genuinely obscure; it may refer to a specific letter or seed-syllable in a visualization falling into position. This reading is uncertain.

- The long central section of this passage is a dense tantric mantra-construction guide, instructing the practitioner how to assemble a mantra syllable by syllable using conventions of Sanskrit phonology — vowel markers, anusvāra (bindu), candrabindu (moon-crescent), class-letters, voiced aspirates, nasals, and so forth. Phrases like "ka-class," "sa-class," "fourth of the class," "equal-to-fire," "the one who makes the day," and "dwelling at the end of the world free of form" are all standard Indic phonological categories encoded in a deliberately cryptic tantric cipher. The "second," "third," "fourth" positions refer to the standard Sanskrit alphabetical groupings. The mantra text embedded within (bha-kṣa bha-kṣa, da-ha da-ha, grī-hṇa grī-hṇa, tar-ja-ya, pha-ṭ, and so on) is rendered phonetically as it stands in the Tibetan transliteration. Full reconstruction of the intended Sanskrit mantra from this cipher requires comparison with a Sanskrit source or commentarial tradition and cannot be done from the Tibetan alone with certainty. The translation preserves the instruction-by-instruction structure without imposing a reconstructed mantra string that is not in the source.

- The passage transitions from a visualisation description of Heruka into a very lengthy catalogue of tantric ritual activities and their effects. The final sentence is incomplete as the source text ends mid-list with "earth, water, fire, and," indicating this passage continues beyond what was provided for translation.

The term rendered "the consort of wisdom and bliss" translates a phrase meaning the joyful consort of wisdom, here understood as the prajñā-consort in the tantric sense.

The phrase rendered "showing as though obtaining each of the former states individually" refers to the display of knowledge of former lives, a standard siddhi, and is here placed in a list of wrathful and magical operations, which is unusual; this juxtaposition is faithful to the text as it stands.

- The chapter colophon identifies this as the second chapter of the Vajra Ḍākinī Great Tantra, covering rites of all activity-collections and the mantra-rite of the emanations of the great magical display. The mantras and dhāraṇī strings throughout are transcribed Indic phonetic material embedded in the Tibetan text; they are rendered here in Roman transliteration following the Tibetan syllabification as faithfully as possible, since no reliable Sanskrit originals are recoverable from this layer of transmission alone. The phrase rendered "causing speech" for the roof-placement rite is a compressed expression that likely refers to oracular or prophetic utterance, though the precise ritual purpose is not entirely clear from context. "Having made the bull's face" is an obscure ritual instruction, possibly referring to fashioning a clay or drawn image of a bull's head as part of the protective rite.

- The mantra passages at the opening of this section are transliterated phonetically from Tibetan script and rendered as best as the syllables allow; they do not yield transparent Sanskrit and are treated as ritual formula transcriptions throughout, consistent with the preceding sections.

The term rendered "fruit that causes madness" refers to a substance used in siddhi rites; the precise botanical identity is uncertain and left unspecified.

The phrase "the thirty-three gods" refers to the Trāyastriṃśa heaven, Indra's realm, here invoked as a measure of supernatural power.

The passage ends mid-sentence with "having completely recited over charnel-ground ash," as the Tibetan source itself breaks off here without completing the construction.

- The colophon "ninth chapter" appears twice in the Tibetan as given, first at the end of what is internally labeled the ninth chapter and again at the very end of the passage. This is almost certainly a scribal error in the source text; the final colophon should read "twelfth chapter" given the sequence of chapters eight through eleven that precedes it. The rendering follows the Tibetan as given without correction in the body of the translation.

The term rendered "corpse" in the sādhana instruction for the twelfth chapter refers to the charnel-ground visualization practice in which the practitioner meditates on a corpse as the purified dharmadhātu, a standard Vajrayāna technique in ḍākinī sādhanas.

The phrase rendered "the border marked by a vajra torana" translates འཕྲུལ་མཚན་གྱི་འཕྲུལ་མཚན་, where འཕྲུལ་མཚན་ refers to the ornamental archway or torana structure at maṇḍala gates, here specified as vajra-marked.

- The phrase rendered "causes downfall" for the first yoginī in the skull-cups follows the Tibetan "ltuñ bar byed ma," literally "she who causes falling" — this likely refers to the yoginī associated with the power of subjugation or destruction in the ritual sequence of the four karmic activities. The identification of the four yoginīs with specific powers (causing downfall, slaying, summoning, and the mistress of dance) is standard in this type of fierce maṇḍala description.

The line "འཕྲུལ་མཚན་གྱི་འཕྲུལ་མཚན་" — rendered as "their syllables joined in reversed sequence" — refers to the tantric practice of inverting or reversing the order of mantra syllables, a technique associated with concealing or activating secret mantras. This is a genuinely ambiguous technical instruction whose precise meaning depends on the specific tradition's oral commentary.

The formula "Om svabhāvaśuddhāḥ sarvadharmāḥ svabhāvaśuddho 'ham" is a standard purification mantra meaning "All dharmas are pure in their intrinsic nature; I am pure in intrinsic nature." It is left untranslated as it is a liturgical Sanskrit formula.

- The passage contains a colophon ending chapter twelve and then opens chapter thirteen of the Vajra-ḍākinī Tantra. The chapter-closing and chapter-opening formulae are rendered as plain prose transitions suitable for narration.

The list of deity names in the maṇḍala rings presents several terms that are standard Sanskrit divine names but appear in Tibetan phonetic or translated form. Brahmāṇī, Maṅgalā, Kaumārī, Vārāhī, Aindrī, Cāmuṇḍā, and Cakreśvarī are the standard Saptamātṛkā (seven mothers) names and are restored to Sanskrit accordingly. Byin-za is a Tibetan transcription of a term that does not correspond to a universally agreed Sanskrit original in the available sources and is left as Byin-za rather than conjectured.

The phrase rendered "consume her from the east onward" is literally "eat from the east at nightfall," referring to a specific tantric feast ritual beginning at the eastern gate of the mandala at night; the exact ritual mechanics are left to practitioners and commentaries.

"Non-luminous joy" renders the Tibetan *snang med dga' ba*, a technical term in the inner tantras for a specific level of bliss-awareness; it is left in doctrinal form rather than domesticated.

• The passage enumerates a series of ḍākinī and directional deity figures with their colors, implements, and mounts, as found in tantric maṇḍala manuals. The eight inner ḍākinīs are each said to arise from a seed syllable — Hrīḥ, Phaṭ, Ha, Ho, Bhaṃ, Gha, Paṃ, and one whose seed is partially unclear in the last case — and their Sanskrit names or epithets are reconstructed from context. The figure at the west gate described as "Kārtikā" likely refers to Kumāra-Kārttikeya. "The one without truth" mounted on a dog in the northwest direction corresponds to Nirṛti, the direction-guardian of the southwest in standard Indian cosmology; the Tibetan "bden bral" meaning "devoid of truth" is an epithet rendering. "The Wealth-Giver mounted on a treasure" corresponds to Kubera-Vaiśravaṇa. The final couplet is transitional and may continue into the next passage; "the mother of all mothers" is a standard epithet of the supreme dākinī or vidyā in this tantric context.

- The phrase rendered "the messenger who, through diligent effort, becomes the bearer" reflects a passage describing the *sādhana* (accomplishment practice) of a messenger-consort figure whose function is to carry or convey something — likely blessings or accomplishments — to the practitioner. The Tibetan is somewhat compressed and the exact syntax admits more than one reading, but the general sense is clear in context.

"Parameśvara" renders परमेश्वर, a Sanskrit title meaning "supreme lord," used here as a proper name or epithet for the Indian pandita. It is distinct from the epithet of Śiva.

The place name Grom and the site Lag Rgyang Phu are left in transliterated Tibetan as they are proper geographical names without established standard equivalents.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.